

Lesson 43: “A Chosen Generation” ([1 Peter 2:9](#)) **1 and 2 Peter; Jude**

Purpose: To help us live in holiness and be a chosen generation.

†1. Bishop Vaughn J. Featherstone

How can the knowledge of our divine potential influence the way we live?

1. Live in faith and holiness as a chosen generation.

- [1 Peter 1:3-4, 18-21](#) Christ “hath begotten us ... to an inheritance ... reserved in heaven for you.”

How should knowing of the Savior’s mission and sacrifice influence our daily actions?

- See [1 Peter 1:13-16, 22-23](#)

- [1 Peter 1:7](#) Why is faith “much more precious than ... gold”?

- 1 Peter 1:10 “The prophets have enquired and searched diligently” for Christ’s salvation.

How do we enquire and search diligently to strengthen our testimony of Christ?

- 2 Peter 2:9-10 What is our responsibility as a chosen generation?

†2. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

†3. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

†4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

2. Follow the Savior’s example in enduring trials and persecution.

- [1 Peter 2:19-24](#) “Christ suffered for us, leaving us an example”

What can we do to follow the Savior’s example in responding to trials and persecution?

What examples have you seen of people who are Christlike in enduring trials?

How are we blessed as we follow the Savior’s example in responding to trials?

†5. J. Golden Kimball

When have you (or someone you know) been persecuted for doing the Lord’s will?

How did Peter counsel us to respond in such circumstances

- See [1 Peter 3:13-17](#); [1 Peter 4:12-19](#)

In what ways do trials give us an opportunity to draw closer to the Lord and to glorify him?

3. Partake of the divine nature and strive to make your calling and election sure.

- [2 Peter 1:4-7](#) Which attributes did Peter describe as part of divine nature?

Why is it important that we develop these qualities? (See [2 Peter 1:8](#))

How have you seen these attributes demonstrated by others?

- 2 Peter 1:10 What does it mean to make your calling and election sure?

†6. Calling and Election Made Sure

What must we do to have our calling and election made sure?

†7. The Prophet Joseph Smith

4. Resist false teachers and those who deny the Second Coming.

Peter and Jude warned of false teachers among Church members.

What did they say were some characteristics of false teachers?

- See [2 Peter 2:1-3, 10, 12-19](#); [Jude 1:4, 8, 10-13, 16, 18-19](#)

How can we recognize false teachers today?

What counsel did Peter and Jude give to help us avoid false teachings and remain faithful?

- See [2 Peter 3:11-14, 17-18](#); [Jude 1:3, 20-21](#); see also [Moroni 7:12-17](#); [D&C 45:57](#); [D&C 46:7-8](#)

([The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles](#): Course Manual (Religion 211-212). Click on “[212 Contents](#)”)

Next Week: New Testament Lesson 44: “God Is Love” 1, 2, and 3 John † •

†1. **Bishop Vaughn J. Featherstone:** “Many years ago I heard the story of the son of King Louis XVI of France. King Louis had been taken from his throne and imprisoned. His young son, the prince, was taken by those who dethroned the king. They thought that inasmuch as the king’s son was heir to the throne, if they could destroy him morally, he would never realize the great and grand destiny that life had bestowed upon him.

“They took him to a community far away, and there they exposed the lad to every filthy and vile thing that life could offer. ... For over six months he had this treatment—but not once did the young lad buckle under pressure. Finally, after intensive temptation, they questioned him. Why had he not submitted himself to these things—why had he not partaken? These things would provide pleasure, satisfy his lusts, and were desirable; they were all his. The boy said, ‘I cannot do what you ask for I was born to be a king’”

“We are all born to be kings in the kingdom of God. Our Father is a king, and just as the king’s son was exposed to every vile and perverted thing in this life, so you will be exposed to much of the filth and degradation of our generation. But you ... are also born to be kings and queens, priests and priestesses” (“[The King’s Son](#),” *New Era*, Nov. 1975, 35).

†2. **Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** “Peculiar, of course, in the Greek rendition should denote not eccentricity but ‘purchased, preserved, treasured, rare.’ ‘Purchased’ denotes being ‘bought’ and freed by Jesus’ atonement.” (*Sermons Not Spoken*, 96) (See also [Peculiar—Bible Dictionary](#) “Peculiar. One’s very own, exclusive, or special; not used in the Bible as odd or eccentric.”)

†3. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “This election to a chosen lineage is based on pre-existent worthiness and is thus made ‘according to the foreknowledge of God.’ (1 Pet. 1:2.) Those so grouped together during their mortal probation have more abundant opportunities to make and keep the covenants of salvation, a right which they earned by pre-existent devotion to the cause of righteousness. As part of this election, Abraham and others of the noble and great spirits were chosen before they were born for the particular missions assigned them in this life. (Abraham. 3:22-24; Rom. 9.)” (*Mormon Doctrine*, 216)

†4. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** defined a chosen generation as “not those living in a particular period or age, but ... the house of Israel both anciently, in the meridian of time, and now in these latter-days. ... [It includes] faithful members of the Church who have taken upon themselves the name of Christ and been adopted into his family” (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 3 vols. [1966–73], 3:294). [[D&C 131:5](#)]. Joseph Smith received this promise from the Lord, as

recorded in [Doctrine and Covenants 132:49](#).” (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. **J. Golden Kimball:** “An incident happened in the Southern States mission, which I will relate. It transpired in the days of President John Morgan, and occurred at a time when the State of Tennessee passed a law that any man who advocated or preached polygamy was to be arrested and punished. Enemies to the Elders entrapped the brethren into a discussion on this most unpopular subject, and the Elders defended the principle from a Biblical standpoint. A complaint was filed, and the Elders were arrested. They were short of room inside the jail, so the brethren, two in number, were confined in two steel cages on the outside, near to each other. The imprisoned servants of the Lord were not orators or singers. The people far and near, hearing of Mormon Elders being under arrest, gathered to see these peculiar individuals. The brethren sang hymns and testified of the truth of the Gospel, etc. It is claimed they had congregations of 300, and I have been told that the people had never heard such wonderful preaching and singing. The Elders almost regretted receiving their freedom. So I am almost inclined to advocate putting our Elders in jail once in a while, when they are unable to get a hearing in any other way.” (Conference Report, Apr 1906)

†6. **Calling and Election Made Sure:** “To receive from the Lord the assurance or promise of exaltation in the celestial kingdom. A person whose calling and election is made sure knows that he or she is ‘sealed up unto eternal life, by revelation and the spirit of prophecy’

†7. **The Prophet Joseph Smith:** “After a person has faith in Christ, repents of his sins, and is baptized for the remission of his sins and receives the Holy Ghost (by the laying on of hands), ... then let him continue to humble himself before God, hungering and thirsting after righteousness, and living by every word of God, and the Lord will soon say unto him, Son, thou shalt be exalted. When the Lord has thoroughly proved him, and finds that the man is determined to serve Him at all hazards, then the man will find his calling and his election made sure” (Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith, sel. Joseph Fielding Smith [1976], 150).

Recommended Conference Talks:

Thomas S. Monson, “[Stand in Holy Places](#),” *Ensign*, November 2011.

Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[Your Potential, Your Privilege](#),” *Ensign*, May 2011.

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